

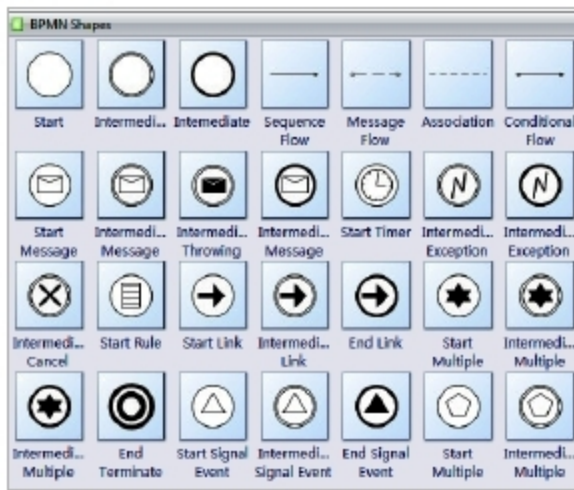


Figure 7: Creating the complete process definition

Check out the website for the detailed steps for creating defining business variables, creating contracts, etc (<https://documentation.bonitasoft.com/bonita/7.8/getting-started-tutorial>).

Design methodology

The design methodology used by Bonita in creating a process-based application is described below.

Setting objectives: Objectives are a vital part of any project to implement or improve a business application or process.

Bonita will not help you to define the objectives for a project, but it will help you create metrics to check that your objectives are met.

Defining the application's scope: Defining the application's scope means defining the people who use it and their usage patterns, the information required, the level of security needed, and connections to external systems. For this, the following things are checked.

- **Application or process:** Is the process completely automatic or does it interact with other processes that have human users? If there is no human interaction, there is no need to create an application.
- **People:** Who owns the application? Who owns the processes in the application? Who uses the application and processes? Who are the key users? Who just needs to know the application exists? When and how is it used? Is it used frequently, on a schedule, in emergencies? Is it used by just one person or by many people at the same time?

- **Information:** What business information does the application need and what information does it deliver? What are the expected results of the processes, and of the application?
- **Security:** What are the kind of controls needed for people using the application? Is a simple login sufficient?
- **Connections:** What connections to external systems are needed? Does the application need to access information in a database, to send email, or to use some other business application? Do these external systems have APIs accessible by Java?

Drawing the process diagram:

Using Bonita Studio, you can quickly sketch out the process flow, and create a diagram of the starting points, main steps, branches, decision points, and end points. Do this for each process in the application. At this stage, get the process owner and the key users to agree on the process flow, before going further.

When drawing a process diagram you might need to check the following.

- Though most business processes have a single start and a single end, it is also possible to have multiple starts and ends.
- If there are activities that happen in parallel, use symmetric gates to map out the beginning and the end of the parallel phases of the process.

Defining the process details: The process details are now defined and they include the following:

- Input and output data of each step, data model, sourcing, storage, and data types
- Details concerning transition and flow, like labels
- Connectors
- Actors
- Monitoring
- Exception handling

- Process maintainability

Designing the application: We can now create the pages and forms needed.

Testing: Test each process individually before testing the application as a whole. The process definition can be validated using Bonita Studio in the *Details* panel and the *Validation* status tab.

Bonita Studio includes an environment for locally testing the processes, before deployment.

It features an example of an organisation, called ACME, which you can use for testing a process or application. When local testing is complete, depending on the environment in which the application will run, you might also need to test the processes in a realistic system before putting the application into production. You could perhaps also put it into production for a limited number of users or cases.

Deployment: When testing is complete, the processes are ready to be deployed in the Bonita portal and the application is ready to be put into production. You need to configure each process for deployment before putting it into production.

Specifying the organisation: Before you can run a process in production, you need to define your organisation with entries for all process users, groups and roles. You also need to map the process actors to the real people who will carry out the process steps. You can manage your organisation in the Bonita portal for a production system. While you are in the testing phase, you can manage the organisation in Bonita Studio.

Monitoring and improvement: After deployment, you can monitor usage and collect key performance indicators, to assess how well the process is meeting the objectives you defined. **END** 🐧

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